

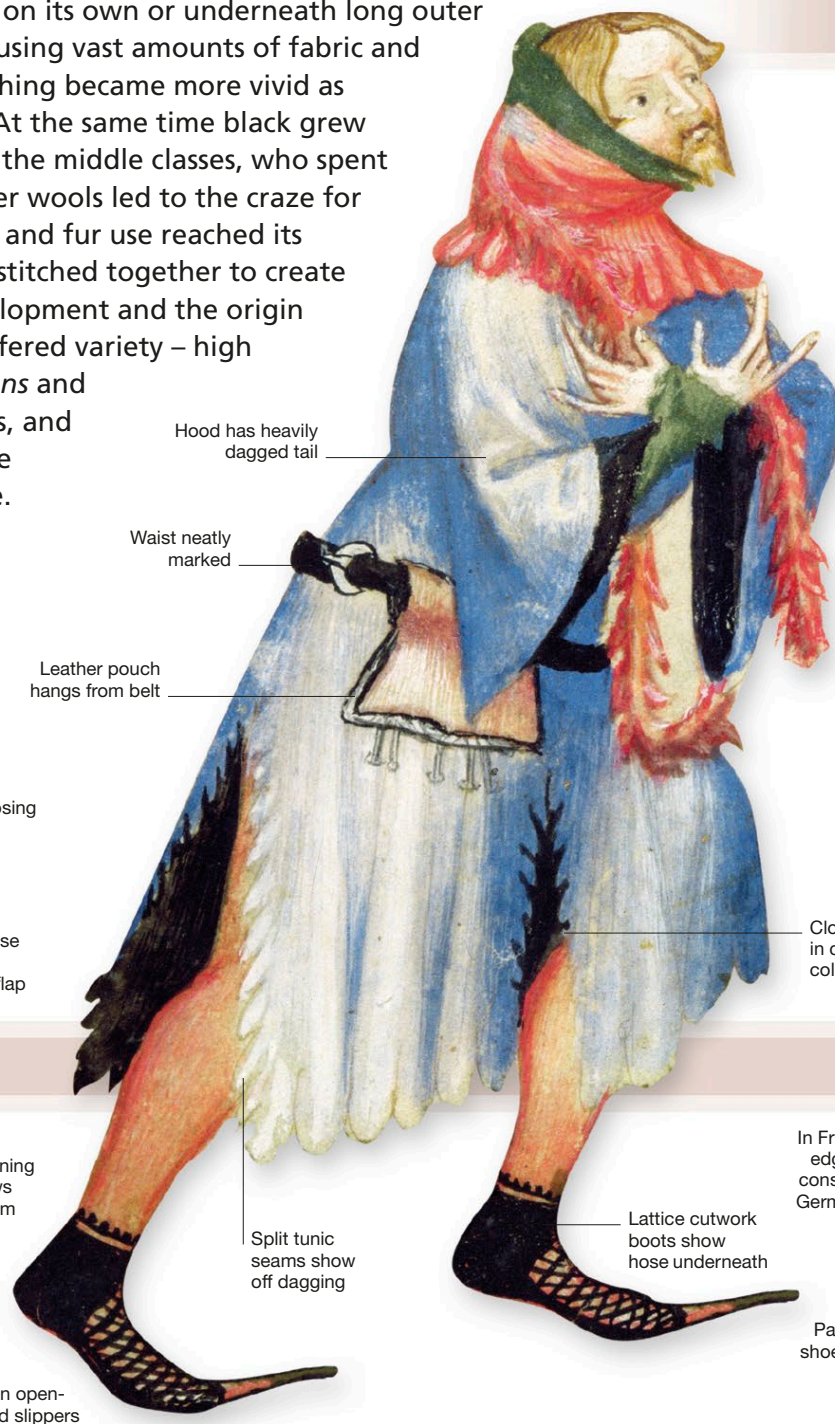
1380–1450

REGIONAL FLAIR

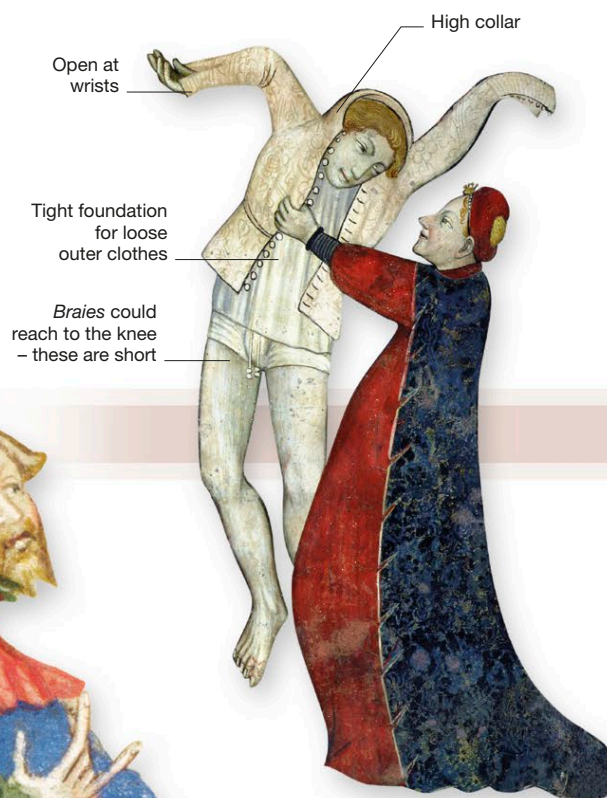
The 15th century saw an eclectic mix of regional styles and the beginnings of trousers. For men, the fitted cote (tunic) became even shorter. It was worn on its own or underneath long outer garments called *houppelandes*, using vast amounts of fabric and bringing back wide sleeves. Clothing became more vivid as dyeing and weaving improved. At the same time black grew more fashionable, especially for the middle classes, who spent more and more on clothes. Better wools led to the craze for cutting raw edges as decoration and fur use reached its peak. Individual hose legs were stitched together to create full-bottomed hose – a key development and the origin of today's trousers. Headgear offered variety – high felt cones, draped cloth *chaperons* and hoods, wide-brimmed straw hats, and large silk and fur bonnets. Sleeve shapes also grew more inventive.



Portable accessories Men and women hung all the items they needed during the day off their belts, a handy way of carrying before pockets. This English man's hat has a liripipe (long tail) draped over his shoulder.



Dagged edges This Italian man from around 1400 wears fashionable wool clothes in different bright colours, with decorative cuts, called dagging, around the edges. The cloth was so tightly woven that edges did not fray. The tight sleeves of a green doublet cover his hands.



Linen underwear A man undressing shows 1420s underclothes. The loose shirt hangs over a pair of short *braies* (fitted underpants). Doublets had many front buttons and a waist seam for a close fit.



Shorter French robe This *haincelin* (shorter robe) has dagged (decoratively cut) edges. The earlier hood became a hat by putting the face hole on top of the head and elegantly arranging the extra material.